

the 'Build Log' tab; you are probably missing packages that can be installed from ctan.org, or even better, from your distribution's package repository.

This article was originally typeset in LATEX2 using Gummi as the editor.

Getting our feet wet

Let us begin with the customary 'Hello World' in LATEX.

```
%Hello World in Latex
\documentclass{article}
\begin{document}
\textbf{Hello \textit{World!}} from \LaTeXe
\end{document}
```

Enter the above code and see what you get.

You would have noted that % starts a comment and that a \ precedes a command. The 'textbf' and 'textit' commands stand for bold and italicised fonts, respectively, and the curly braces enclose the arguments of the command.

A typical article template would look like what's shown below:

```
%This is a simple template to learn and
%practice basic constructs of LaTeX.
%Paste this template into a LaTeX editor
%or save this template as a .tex file and
%run 'pdflatex' on it to get a PDF file.
```

```
\documentclass[10pt,a4paper]{article}
%The square brackets contain arguments.
%The 'twocolumn' argument gives you two-
%column text. Some other document
%classes are 'book' and 'letter'.
%<----- Preamble of Document ----->
%The document title.
\title{\textbf{Title Of Article}}
\author{Author1 \& Author2 \& etc.}
\date{} %\switches off date. Delete this
%if you want the date to appear.
%The \today command inserts today's date.
```

```
\begin{document}
\maketitle %necessary to create the title.
%You can divide the article into section,
%subsection, subsection, and paragraph.
%Add a '*' after 'section' if you want
%hierarchical section numbering
%to be suppressed; but this might also
%suppress production of the PDF outline
%and the TOC.
```

```
\section{Section Title}
%-----Your Content Here----->
```

Just keep typing. The text gets typeset automatically.

Leaving a blank line starts a new para. A double back slash forces a blank line.

```
\subsection{Subsection Title}
%Content
```

```
\subsubsection{Subsubsection Title}
%Content
```

```
\end{document}
```

With the above template as a starting point for experimentation, and with a little help from the links in the *References* section, you are well on your way to learning as much LATEX as you need. Let's try to learn some basic constructs in LATEX in the rest of this article.

Quick recipes

Specialised LATEX functionality is bundled within so-called packages. The default installation, however, gives you standard typesetting sufficient for most purposes.

Lists

Enumerated lists can be typeset as follows:

```
\begin{enumerate}
\item
Item 1
\item
Item 2
\item
etc.
\end{enumerate}
```

...and would appear as:

1. Item 1
2. Item 2
3. etc.

You can explore other kinds of lists in LATEX by yourself. Replacing 'enumerate' by 'itemise' gives you a bulleted list.

Tables

The following is an example of a table insertion. It is fairly intuitive. Note how the left and right columns are respectively right- and left-justified for the purpose of illustration.

FOSS Technology	Description
Apache	Web Server
Blender	3D-Modeller
LibreOffice	Office Suite

Table 1: Example of a table